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# CHILD CARE PARENT HANDBOOK

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Welcome to **August Home Daycare!**

We are so happy to welcome your family into our daycare community. Thank you for trusting us to care for your little one!

This Parent Handbook was created to help you learn more about our daycare, daily routines, policies, and what you can expect from us. We hope it helps make the transition smooth and keeps communication between us clear and easy.



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**Welcome** to August Home Daycare! Created with love and care, we are a family-focused daycare where children are welcomed with open arms, supported with kindness, and encouraged to grow in their own unique way.

### August Mission

To create meaningful experiences and trusted services that inspire growth, build connections, and make a positive difference in the lives of the people and communities we serve.

### August Vision

To inspire confidence in families by providing trusted care, building meaningful relationships, and growing together as a community.

### August Core Values

Growth Respect Integrity Kindness Inclusion Excellence

## Daycare Information

### Services Available

Full-Time & Part-Time Childcare

Evening Child Care

Drop-In

### Hours & Days of Operation

#### Regular Child Care

Monday – Friday  
6:30 AM – 5:30 PM

#### Evening Child Care

Monday – Friday  
6:30 PM – 10:00 PM

#### Drop-In Child Care

Available during operating hours, based on space availability and advance booking (24 hrs prior).

#### Closed:

Saturday, Sunday, and scheduled holidays.



## Holiday Closures

August Daycare will be closed on the following statutory holidays. Families will receive advance notice of all planned closures.

 New Year's Day

 Family Day

 Good Friday

 Victoria Day

 Canada Day

 Saskatchewan Day

 Labour Day

 Thanksgiving Day

 Remembrance Day

 Christmas Day

## Additional Planned Closures

- Christmas Eve (December 24) – We will close at 2 PM
- Boxing Day (December 26) – Closed
- Christmas Holiday Break (December 27–31) – Closed
- Emergency closures due to severe weather, safety concerns, or circumstances affecting the safety of children and the child care provider

## Daily Activities Schedule & Program Policy

The daily schedule is a guide and may be adjusted based on:

- Children's ages and individual needs
- Children's interests and engagement
- Weather conditions
- Health and safety considerations
- Unexpected circumstances
- Staffing requirements

Flexibility allows us to provide the best possible care while maintaining a safe and positive environment for all children.



## Daily Schedule

| Time                | Activity                                                                                                                  |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6:30 AM – 8:30 AM   | Arrival & Welcome Period • Free play • Individual routines                                                                |
| 8:30 AM – 9:00 AM   | Breakfast/Morning Snack • Hygiene routine                                                                                 |
| 9:00 AM – 10:30 AM  | Learning & Development Activities • Circle time • Stories • Music • Arts & crafts • Sensory play • Educational activities |
| 10:30 AM – 11:30 AM | Outdoor Play & Exploration (weather permitting) • Gross motor activities • Nature exploration                             |
| 11:30 AM – 12:30 PM | Lunch • Clean-up • Diapering/toileting routines                                                                           |
| 12:30 PM – 2:30 PM  | Rest Period • Nap Time • Quiet activities for children who do not sleep                                                   |
| 2:30 PM – 3:00 PM   | Afternoon Snack • Hygiene routines                                                                                        |
| 3:00 PM – 4:30 PM   | Outdoor Play / Indoor Activities • Creative play • Social activities                                                      |
| 4:30 PM – 5:30 PM   | Quiet Play • Parent Pick-Up                                                                                               |

## Meals and Snacks

-  Nutritious meals and snacks will be provided based on children's age and daily needs.
-  Children will be supervised during meals and encouraged to develop healthy eating habits.
-  Children will not be forced to eat.
-  Parents must inform the daycare of any allergies, dietary restrictions, or special requirements.
-  **August Home Daycare is a nut-free environment. Peanuts and tree nuts are not permitted.**
-  Proper food handling, hygiene, and sanitation practices will always be followed.

*Please note that 2% or Homogenized milk is provided for children 18 months or older, but formula is not.*



## Nut-Free Policy

- August Home Daycare is a **nut-free environment** to help protect children with nut allergies.
- Parents are asked not to send foods containing **peanuts or tree nuts**
- Families must inform the daycare of any food allergies or dietary restrictions.

Reasonable precautions will be taken; however, August Home Daycare cannot guarantee a completely allergen-free environment.

## Drop-Off Policy

### Arrival Time & Hours

- For the safety and proper supervision of all children, drop-offs are only permitted during the following hours
  - **Regular Child Care** between 6:30 AM to 9:00 AM
  - **Evening Child Care** after 6:30 PM
  - **Note:** Children will not be allowed to be dropped off outside these hours (Fee may apply)
- The daycare entrance will open at **6:30 AM**.

## Parent/Guardian Drop-Off Responsibilities

Parents/guardians are responsible for:

- Bringing their child safely to the designated daycare entrance.
- Ensuring the child is transferred directly into the care of the childcare provider.
- Informing the provider of any important updates and **leave a written copy** before leaving, including:
  - Changes in sleep routine
  - Health concerns
  - Medication needs
  - Mood or behaviour changes
  - Any important information affecting the child's day
- Ensuring all required belongings are brought inside and properly labeled.

**IMPORTANT:** *Children must not be left unattended at the entrance, driveway, yard, or any area outside the daycare.*

*August Home Daycare reserves the right to refuse care if a child arrives showing symptoms that may affect the health and safety of other children and provider.*



## Arrival Transition

Parents/guardians are encouraged to keep drop-off routines positive, calm, and consistent.

To support a smooth transition:

- Parents should allow enough time for arrival, greetings, and sharing important information.
- Once the child has been signed in and accepted into care, *parents/guardians are expected to leave promptly to support supervision and the daily routine.*

## Pick-Up Policy

To ensure the safety and security of all children, families must follow the pick-up procedures below:

- Children must be picked up on or before their scheduled pick-up time and no later than:
  - **Regular Child Care 5:30 PM**
  - **Evening Child Care 10:00 PM**
- A **late pickup fee** of **\$20** will apply for the **first 15 minutes** after the scheduled pickup time. An additional **\$1** per minute fee will be charged for every minute thereafter until the parent or authorized pickup person arrives.
- Families **must provide written notice** of any changes to pick-up arrangements, including changes to authorized pick-up persons.
- Children will only be released to individuals listed as authorized pick-up persons on the enrollment form.
- Authorized pick-up persons may be required to provide identification before the child is released.
- Families must notify the provider as soon as possible if an unexpected delay occurs. ***Late fees may apply and will be automatically charged to the family's account.***
- If a child is not picked up, August Home Daycare will contact the parent/guardian and emergency contacts. If no one answers, we will call local authorities or child protection services.
- Once the child has been released to the parent/guardian or authorized person, responsibility and supervision of the child transfers to the family.
- Families must use designated parking areas and ensure they do not block neighbours' driveways or access areas.
- Children will not be accepted or remain in care outside of approved operating hours unless prior arrangements have been approved by August Home Daycare.

***Thank you for helping us maintain a safe, respectful, and organized childcare environment.***

## Authorized Adults

Only parents/guardians and individuals authorized by the family may drop off or pick-up a child. Families must provide written authorization for any new person picking up or dropping off their child. **Note:** The childcare provider may request identification from any unfamiliar individual before releasing or accepting a child.



## Parking & Safety

Families must:

- Use the designated daycare driveway or legal street parking directly in front of the home during drop-off and pick-up.
- Ensure vehicles do not block sidewalks, driveways, entrances, or access areas.
- **Not Park on, block, or interfere with neighbours' driveways or private property under any circumstances.**
- Follow all local parking regulations and signage.
- Complete drop-off and pick-up safely while being respectful of our neighbours and surrounding community.
- Supervise children while entering and leaving the property.
- Ensure gates, doors, and entrances are securely closed after arrival.

**Note:** Children must remain with their parent/guardian until they are safely transferred into the provider's care.

## Supplies and Personal Belongings

To ensure your child is comfortable, safe, and prepared for each day, parents/guardians are responsible for providing and maintaining the following items. All belongings must be clearly **labeled with your child's first and last name.**

## Daily Requirements

Parents/Guardians are responsible for providing:

- 2 sets of a complete change of clothing appropriate for the season.
- Indoor shoes (if applicable).
- Weather-appropriate outdoor clothing, including:
  - Jacket
  - Hat
  - Mittens or gloves
  - Snow pants (winter)
  - Waterproof boots
  - Rain gear, when needed
- Diapers, pull-ups, and baby wipes (if applicable).
- Formula, breast milk, or baby food (if applicable).
- A labeled water bottle.
- Any comfort item your child requires for rest time (small blanket or stuffed toy, if desired).



## Medication

If your child requires medication during daycare hours:

- Medication must be provided in its original labeled container.
- A completed Medication Authorization Form must be signed before any medication will be administered.
- Parents are responsible for ensuring medications are not expired and are replaced as needed.

## Clothing Expectations

Children participate in indoor and outdoor activities daily. Parents must dress their child appropriately for the weather and activities.

Children who arrive without appropriate clothing or footwear may be unable to participate in outdoor play.

## Personal Belongings

Parents are encouraged to leave toys, electronics, jewelry, money, and other valuables at home unless requested for a special activity. **August Home Daycare is not responsible for lost, stolen, or damaged personal belongings brought from home.**

## Maintaining Supplies

Parents are responsible for monitoring and replenishing their child's supplies before they run out.

If essential items (such as diapers, wipes, formula, or a change of clothes) are not provided, the daycare may:

- Contact the parent to bring the required items immediately.
- Use emergency supplies, if available, and charge a replacement fee.
- Refuse care if the missing items affect the child's health, safety, or ability to participate in the program.

## Parent/Guardian(s) Responsibility

It is the parent's responsibility to ensure their child arrives each day:

- Healthy and well enough to participate.
- Properly dressed for the weather.
- With all required supplies.
- With updated emergency contact information and any changes provided in writing.

**Failure to provide required supplies on a repeated basis may result in additional fees, suspension of services, or termination of care in accordance with the Agreement Contract.**



## Photography & Video Policy

To protect the privacy and safety of all children and families, August Home Daycare follows the guidelines below:

- Photos and videos may be taken to document children's activities and learning.
- Media Release Authorization (part of Enrollment form) is required before a child's image/video is used for the daycare's website, social media, or promotional materials.
- Parents may withdraw their consent at any time by providing written notice. This applies only to future use.
- Parents and visitors are **NOT** permitted to photograph or record other children while on daycare property.
- August Home Daycare will take reasonable steps to protect all photos and videos but cannot guarantee the security of electronic storage or transmission.
- August Home Daycare is not responsible for any unauthorized sharing, copying, or distribution of images by parent/guardian(s) or third parties.

## Health & Safety Policies

### Accident & Injury

- Children will be supervised to help prevent accidents and injuries.
- Minor injuries will receive first aid and parents will be informed.
- Incident reports will be completed when required.
- In an emergency, parents and emergency services will be contacted.

### Nap & Rest Time

- Daily rest/quiet time will be provided based on each child's needs.
- Children will have a safe and supervised rest area.
- Children who do not sleep will participate in quiet activities.

### Smoking & Vaping

- August Home Daycare is a smoke-free and vape-free environment.
- Smoking, vaping, cannabis, and tobacco products are not permitted inside the home, daycare areas, or around children.

### Emergency Evacuation Plan

- Children will be safely evacuated during emergencies.
- Attendance will be checked before and after evacuation.
- Emergency contacts will be notified when required.

### Food

- Children will be provided with safe, age-appropriate meals and snacks.
- Parents must provide information about dietary needs and restrictions.
- Children will always be supervised while eating.

### Allergy

- Parents must disclose all allergies and medical needs.
- Emergency plans and required medications must be provided.
- Reasonable precautions will be taken to reduce allergy risks.



## Outdoor Play

- Outdoor play will be provided when weather conditions are safe.
- Parents must provide appropriate clothing for the weather.
- Children will be supervised during all outdoor activities.

## Confidentiality

- Child and family information will be kept private and confidential.
- Information will only be shared when required by law, in emergencies, or with parent permission.

## Registration Process

- Parents/guardians may contact August Home Daycare to inquire about availability via email or call.
- If no space is available, families may be added to the waitlist. Being on the waitlist does **not guarantee enrollment**.
- Parents/guardians are responsible for keeping their contact information current and responding to daycare communication.
- August Home Daycare follows a first-come, first-served based on the application date and the child's age
- Priority is given to siblings of children already enrolled.
- Enrollment is only confirmed once all required registration forms are completed, the Agreement is signed, and any required fees are paid.
- August Home Daycare reserves the right to approve or decline enrollment based on available space and the ability to meet the child's needs.

## Tour

We welcome families to learn more about August Home Daycare.

- Visit our website at [augustdaycare.ca](http://augustdaycare.ca) for a virtual tour
- In-person tours are available by appointment to ensure the safety and routine of the child care providers and children in our care. Contact us via email or call.



## Payment Policy and Fee Schedule

Once you have accepted a space, we will require a **\$100 non-refundable** application fee per child/family at the time of your child/ren's enrollment.

### Payment Policy

- A non-refundable deposit equal to one month's fees is required. This deposit will be applied to the final month of care, provided proper notice is given.
- Fees are charged regardless of child attendance, including illness or vacation.
- A minimum of **30 days** written notice is required to withdraw from care or payment in lieu of notice.

### Fee Schedule

| Child Care                                                           | Monthly Plan (\$)       |                                       |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| <b>Infant</b><br><b>8 mos. – 18 mos.</b><br>(8mos.- 1.5 year)        | <i>Full-time</i>        | 1280/month                            |
|                                                                      | <i>Part-time</i>        | 850/month<br><i>(2.5 days a week)</i> |
| <b>Toddler</b><br><b>18 mos.– 30 mos.</b><br>(1.5 years-2.5 years)   | <i>Full-time</i>        | \$1150/month                          |
|                                                                      | <i>Part-time</i>        | 760/month<br><i>(2.5 days a week)</i> |
| <b>Preschool</b><br><b>30 mos. – 5 years</b><br>(2.5 years- 5 years) | <i>Full-time</i>        | 1000/month                            |
|                                                                      | <i>Part-time</i>        | 660/month<br><i>(2.5 days a week)</i> |
| Rates for:<br><b>Drop-in</b><br><b>Evening Care</b>                  | \$15.00 per hour        |                                       |
|                                                                      | Min of 3-hour (\$45.00) | Maximum of \$60.00/day                |



## Before & After School Program

| Program                                 | Monthly                                    | Add-on (Existing Families)              | Before School Only                | After School Only |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------|
| School Age<br>(6 years & up)            | \$650/month<br><i>(Sept-June)</i>          | \$500/month<br><i>(Sept-June)</i>       | \$15/day                          | \$25/day          |
|                                         | \$1000/month<br><i>(July &amp; August)</i> | 850/month<br><i>(July &amp; August)</i> | Before + After School<br>\$35/day |                   |
| Daily Rate<br>PD Day/<br>School Closure | \$60/day                                   |                                         |                                   |                   |

## Before & After School Program includes:

- Before school care starting at 6:30 AM
- School drop-off (if St. Francis Community School)
- After school pickup (if St. Francis Community School)
- Care until 5:30 PM
- Snack included

## Payment Methods

- cheques (payable to August Home Daycare),
- debit and credit
- e-transfer ([august.daycare@outlook.com](mailto:august.daycare@outlook.com))

Cash payments are not accepted.

All fees are non-refundable except for overpayments by parent/guardian(s).

## Payment Due

Childcare fees are due **on the 1<sup>st</sup> of each month** and must be paid on or before the agreed-upon payment date. Payment is required regardless of attendance, including absences due to illness, vacations, statutory holidays, or personal reasons, unless otherwise stated in your childcare agreement.

## Late Payments / Overdue accounts

Payments not received by the due date may be subject to:

- A late payment fee of **2%** of the total balance, 5 days after the due date.
- Parents with accounts past due will be notified by emailed letter.
- Suspension of childcare services until the account is brought current.
- Termination of childcare services if payments remain outstanding.

The daycare reserves the right to refuse care for overdue accounts.



## NSF (Returned) Cheques

A fee of **\$50** will be charged for any cheque returned due to insufficient funds or any other banking issue. Future payments may be required by credit card, debit card, or e-Transfer only.

## E-Transfers

E-Transfers must be sent to the daycare's designated email address and include the child's full name in the message or memo field. Payment is not considered received until the transfer has been successfully deposited.

## Credit and Debit Card Payments

Parents are responsible for ensuring that their payment information is current and that sufficient funds or available credit are available. Declined payments are considered unpaid and may be subject to the late payment policy.

## Outstanding Balances

The daycare reserves the right to:

- Apply payments to the oldest outstanding balance first.
- Suspend or terminate childcare services for unpaid accounts.
- Pursue collection of outstanding balances through legal or collection processes where permitted by law. Parents are responsible for any reasonable costs incurred in recovering unpaid amounts, where permitted by applicable law.

## No Deductions or Withholding

Parents may not withhold or reduce payment due to illness, vacation, dissatisfaction with services, temporary closures required by law, or missed attendance, except where required by law or specifically agreed to in writing by the daycare.

## Receipts

Receipts will be provided for all payments received and annual receipts will be issued for eligible childcare expenses in accordance with applicable tax requirements.

## Policy Changes

The daycare reserves the right to amend this Payment Policy at any time. Families will receive reasonable notice before changes take effect.

**By enrolling your child, you acknowledge that you have read, understood, and agree to comply with this Payment Policy.**



## Abuse Prevention & Respectful Conduct Policy

August Home Daycare is committed to maintaining a safe, respectful, and professional environment for all children, families, and the childcare provider.

- Any form of abuse, neglect, threats, harassment, intimidation, discrimination, or aggressive behavior toward children, families, or the childcare provider will not be tolerated.
- Children will always be treated with patience, dignity, and respect. Physical punishment or harmful discipline is strictly prohibited.
- Parents/guardians are expected to communicate respectfully and work cooperatively with the childcare provider.
- Concerns or disagreements must be addressed in a respectful manner and through appropriate communication.

Any behavior that creates an unsafe, hostile, or disrespectful environment may result in suspension or termination of childcare services.

## Parent Handbook Updates & Revisions

This Handbook provides important information about our policies, procedures, expectations, and responsibilities for families enrolled in our daycare.

Policies and procedures may be updated or revised from time to time to reflect changes in childcare practices, operational needs, or applicable requirements. Parents/guardians will be notified of any significant updates and may be required to review and acknowledge changes.

By enrolling your child at August Home Daycare, you agree to follow the current policies and procedures outlined in the most recent version of the Child Care Parent Handbook.



## Parent Handbook Acknowledgment & Sign-Off

-  I acknowledge that I have received, read, and understand the **August Home Daycare Child Care Parent Handbook**.
-  I agree to follow all policies, procedures, and requirements outlined in the handbook.
-  I understand my responsibilities and the requirements expected of parents/guardians of children enrolled

**Child's/Children's Name:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Parent/Guardian (Printed Name):** \_\_\_\_\_

**Parent/Guardian Signature:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Date:** \_\_\_\_\_